have seen a massive surge. What were the key strategic decisions contributing to this growth?

It is often said that making the first million is the toughest; subsequent millions follow more easily. It took us 15-20 years of hard work to establish a solid foundation. Creating an FMCG brand requires substantial investment in distribution, marketing, and other critical areas. Only when we reached a certain scale did we start benefiting from operating leverage. Over the past six to seven years, Radico has experienced significant growth, with our share prices increasing by approximately 8 to 10 times. The exact figures can be obtained for precision, but this surge is largely due to how the market perceives us and our achievements.

When I joined the company, our market cap was around 4 crores; today, it stands at Rs. 23,000 crores. This remarkable growth can be attributed to my vision, a successful premiumization strategy and dedicated collaborative efforts of Team Radico under the leadership of our COO - Amar Sinha, whose strategic foresight and precise execution have been instrumental in propelling Radico towards unprecedented growth in the last half a decade. We have consistently introduced premium and luxury brands like Magic Moments, Morpheus, and Rampur. Rampur, for instance, now offers seven expressions, including a limited edition of 400 bottles, with the last few selling at Hyderabad Duty-Free for 5 lakhs per bottle. The range starts at $100 and goes up to Rs. 500,000 per bottle. Our latest venture, Jaisalmer Indian Craft Gin, is priced at Rs. 3,700, double the price of many other Indian gins. Despite the higher price point, Jaisalmer commands more than 50% of the market share, highlighting the success of our premiumization strategy. Our ability to create and sustain premium and luxury brands has been a key factor in gaining market confidence and driving our share prices upward.

- **How did you achieve market acceptance for these luxury items priced as high as Rs. 500,000 a bottle?**

Achieving market acceptance for these high-priced luxury items involves several key factors. Firstly, the packaging and the name must be unique and tell a compelling story. Most importantly, the quality of the liquid is paramount, especially for such premium products.

Our distillation expertise is a significant strength, with our malt plant being one of the oldest in India, established in 1992. This ensures the liquid's quality is exceptional. Additionally, effective distribution strategies are essential to reach the right audience.

The proof of quality is also in the awards we've received. Numerous whisky experts and writers have praised Rampur, enhancing its credibility. Thus, it's a combination of high-quality liquid, unique packaging, strategic distribution, and industry recognition that has driven the market acceptance of our luxury products.

- **Can you describe the tasting notes and unique characteristics of some of your most popular products?**

Out of my various brands, two in particular stand out: Rampur Asava and Jaisalmer Gold. Rampur Asava is unique because it is the first Indian single malt matured in bourbon casks and finished in Indian wine casks. The name "Asava" is derived from the Sanskrit word for wine. This gives Rampur Asava a velvety and sweet taste with a rich, dark color. It's currently sold overseas, but we plan to introduce it to the Indian market soon due to increasing demand.